



**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
KEMENTERIAN SUMBER MANUSIA
ARAS 7-8, BLOK D4, KOMPLEK D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN PERSEKUTUAN
62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN (*INFORMATION SHEET*)

KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM / <i>PROGRAM CODE AND NAME</i>	Z-009-3:2015 CORE ABILITIES	
TAHAP / LEVEL	3 (THREE)	
NO DAN TAJUK KEBOLEHAN TERAS / <i>CORE ABILITY NO AND TITLE</i>	CA03 LEADERSHIP SKILLS	
NO DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN / <i>ABILITY NO AND STATEMENT</i>	03.01 DEMONSTRATE COUNSELLING ABILITIES 03.02 DEMONSTRATE RESPONSIBILITY AND AUTHORITY ABILITIES 03.03 DEMONSTRATE TEAM WORK ABILITIES 03.04 DEMONSTRATE EMOTIONAL CONTROL IN CONFLICTS 03.05 APPLY WORK KNOWLEDGE IN IDENTIFYING CLIENTS' NEED 03.06 MONITOR WORK PERFORMANCE DELIVERIES	
NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015-M03/P(1/6)	Muka Surat / Page : 1 Drpd / of : 7

TAJUK/TITLE : COUNSELLING AT WORK PLACE

TUJUAN/PURPOSE :

This Information Sheet is intended to describe basic counselling abilities, including needs assessment, situational analysis and techniques for running a successful counselling session or program. The person who is competent in this Module will become a more effective leader as he/she is able to reduce problems and extract the best performance from his/her team through good counselling practices.

NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3: 2015-M03/P(1/6)	Mukasurat / Page : 2 Drpd / of : 7
---------------------------	---------------------------------	---

PENERANGAN/INFORMATION :

1. Introduction To Counselling

1.1 Counselling is a type of talking therapy that allows a person to talk about their problems and feelings in a confidential and dependable environment.

A counsellor is trained to listen with empathy and trust. Most of us have been an informal counsellors whether to friends or siblings but few of us would have had any guidance on how to perform the counsellor role effectively for the benefit of the other party.

1.2 In the workplace, counselling is often undertaken by qualified professionals. Nonetheless, good supervisors should develop their coaching skills and counselling abilities and apply them in all situations where they are giving one-off advice to their subordinate or peers, or becoming a coach or mentor to others for an extended period. Aside from helping to improve their team's growth and performance, good coaching skills and counselling abilities help to create a caring culture within the team and good rapport between leaders and members, which boosts staff retention and team performance.

2. Communication Skill

2.1 Communication skills are obviously of utmost importance to counsellors. It includes active listening, clarification, reflection and effective questioning skill.

2.2 The style of communication which you should practice throughout counselling is empathetic communication. And empathetic communicator has the capacity to understand the unique experiences of somebody else, and respond to them effectively. Some of the key elements of this type of communication are:

- i) Asking open-ended questions which invite a deeper answer, not Yes / No questions. E.g. Ask questions like "So tell me more about...", and "Tell me more about why that is important to you....". This allows you to explore the issue jointly with the person you are counselling.
- ii) Slow down, give the person your full attention and let the story unfold.
 - a. Avoid the temptation to recommend a quick fix or tell the person where
 - b. they went wrong, even if it's very obvious to you.

NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3: 2015-M03/P(1/6)	Mukasurat / Page : 3 Drpd / of : 7
---------------------------	---------------------------------	---

- iii) Be firm. The person you are counselling will often resist opening up, or try to change the subject when the topic becomes uncomfortable. You should point this out and emphasize that it is important to pursue the topic. No pain no gain!
- iv) Become an avid listener. You should aim to be listening to your colleague 80% of the time, and talking only 20% of the time. Avid listening means you are not letting your mind wander off when the person is talking, or already thinking about your response, or only listening to some parts, or filtering out what you don't like to hear based on your personal prejudices.
- v) Avid listeners practice behaviours like acknowledging the talker with nodding and eye contact, probing for more information, reflecting feelings (e.g. "It seems like you felt _____ during that situation") and summarizing what you heard and asking for validation to ensure you really understood.

3. Coaching Skill

3.1 With the right Counselling Abilities and Communication Skills, you are ready to run a counselling session. This Coaching Skills section lists what a counselling session should typically cover.

3.2 A counselling session can normally be broken into four steps:

i) Identify the need.

This is when you decide whether you are the right person to be the counsellor, or else delegate to your peer. You do your research to collect the data and inputs from counsellee during your session, observe the situation (events or issues), compare the current situation and focus on two way communication session.

ii) Prepare for counselling

a) Select a suitable place.

b) Establish the right atmosphere, light and receptive introductions, introduce light chit-chat and ensuring the comfort of the counsellee.

c) Outline the session components. Stating the reason for the session, e.g.

"I have observed that you have had some issues with work quality in this last month. Before this you were one of our most dependable members of my team."

d) Stating the desired outcome of the session, e.g. "I want to understand why this is happening and see how we can work together to solve any

NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3: 2015-M03/P(1/6)	Mukasurat / Page : 4 Drpd / of : 7
---------------------------	---------------------------------	---

issues, not just to go back to how thing were, but so that you can progress to the next stage in your career.”

- e) Stating how you will run the session, e.g. ”This is an informal session, everything is confidential and off-the-record. I will be listening a lot and

will be asking some questions. I am not going to judge. Only when you have finished sharing will we start looking at solutions. I want us to work jointly towards a solution.”

iii) Conduct the counselling session

- a) Open the session by discussing the issue.

- What is causing the causes
- What emotions he / she is feeling
- What his / her hopes and priorities are

- b) Developing the plan of action.

- c) Recording and closing the session

iv) Follow up

- a) Discussions of possible solutions. It’s best to let the employee lead this, but you can make suggestions

- b) Adoption of best solution, and resulting Action Plan. Again, let the counsellor lead, and you ensure they stay within reasonable parameters.

- c) Agree to bring in other help or escalate to the next level if needed.

- d) Mutual commitment to the Action Plan, including what you will be doing to help.

- e) Agree on what goal you are hoping to achieve, and when to review the results next.

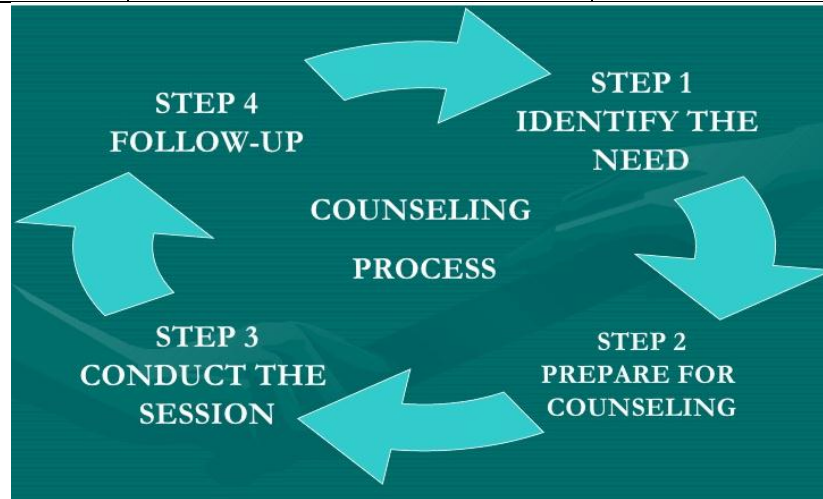


Figure 3 – Counselling Process

4. Cultural awareness

4.1 Be aware that gender, race and personality styles may play a part in whether you can be an effective counsellor to another party.

4.2 It is not always the case that a lady must be counseled by a lady, or that both must be from the same race. Often it helps for an employee to speak to someone from a different background who might be able to look at the issue from a fresh perspective, or have fresh solutions. This decision should be evaluated on a case-by-case basis.

4.3 When counseling someone from a different background, be extra careful to understand the context of their lives, and extra careful to check your own prejudices and biases. The best counsellors will be able to put themselves into the shoes of the person they are counseling and will be able to exercise respect and empathy towards anyone from any background.

5. Counselling abilities

5.1 Counselling Abilities is a specific soft skills which you will need to cultivate in order to be an effective counsellor when needed. You can think of them as the pre-requisites for starting and continuing a counselling session. They are five basic abilities to become a good counsellor:-

- i) You need to be able to build a trusting and safe relationship with the person

NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3: 2015-M03/P(1/6)	Mukasurat / Page : 6 Drpd / of : 7
---------------------------	---------------------------------	---

- ii) you are counselling. If you and he / she do not get on well, then you are probably not the right person to provide him / her with counselling and you may have to delegate to another peer.
- iii) You need to be committed to understanding and genuinely helping the person you are counselling. This means you need to be able to listen without judging or criticizing, and to keep an open mind until you have all the facts, understand his/her emotions and understand the full context of the problem. Don't work towards a solution until you have done all this. And don't pretend you have a solution when you don't; it's always better to seek help.
- iv) You need to have emotional intelligence. This means you can understand different emotions which you are observing, control them and use this information about emotions to guide your counselling session.
- v) You need to be an effective role model, and practice what you preach. E.g. you cannot advice someone to take things positively if you yourself are constantly negative. Model the types of good behaviours you are advocating to others. People do not trust someone who does not seem genuine.
- vi) You need to be in full control of your own emotions, such as anger, defensiveness, annoyance, regardless of what is being said or who is being blamed by the employee.

5.2 As a Counsellor, you need to be self-aware of your own shortcomings and abilities. Only when you are satisfied with your own Counselling Abilities, should you proceed to performing a counselling session, adopting suitable Communication Skills and Coaching Skills to match the situation.

NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3: 2015-M03/P(1/6)	Mukasurat / Page : 7 Drpd / of : 7
---------------------------	---------------------------------	---

SOALAN/QUESTION :

1. What are the key Counselling Abilities that counselors should possess?
2. What are some of the techniques for empathetic listening?
3. What are the 4 stages for running a counselling session?

RUJUKAN / REFERENCES:

1. Stephen E. Kohn & Vincent D. O' Connell. (2015) 9 Powerful Practices of Really Great Mentors. Advantage Quest Publications. ISBN-13: 978-967-0789-24-8
2. http://www.armystudyguide.com/content/army_board_study_guide_topics/counseling/the-counseling-process.html